

DANISH AHMED

Red Team Operator | Penetration Tester | Offensive Security Specialist

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HackTheBox: #1 in Pakistan • TryHackMe: Top 5% • linkedin.com/in/danish-ahmed-61927b265

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Offensive security specialist with 1.5+ years of hands-on Red Teaming and Penetration Testing experience across web applications, networks, Active Directory, and cloud environments. Ranked #1 in Pakistan on Hack The Box (GURU rank, featured in NASA Hall of Fame). Certified in Red Teaming (CRTA, CRTOM, CCEP) and Penetration Testing (CPTS, CEH). Proven ability to simulate real-world adversarial attacks, conduct phishing campaigns, and deliver actionable security reports. Immediately available; notice period under 1 month.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Web Application Penetration Testing • Network Penetration Testing • Red Team Operations • Active Directory Attacks
Phishing & Social Engineering • Exploit Development • Post-Exploitation & Lateral Movement • Security Report Writing
• Bug Bounty Hunting • CTF Competitions • Linux & Windows Exploitation • Cloud & Infrastructure Security

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Red Team Operator | VulnHat (Remote Internship)

Dec 2023 – Jun 2024

- Executed end-to-end red team engagements simulating real-world adversarial attack scenarios against client environments
- Performed advanced web application penetration testing identifying OWASP Top 10 vulnerabilities including SQL injection, XSS, SSRF, and authentication bypasses
- Conducted network penetration testing including internal network reconnaissance, MITM attacks, and lateral movement across enterprise environments
- Developed and executed phishing campaigns and social engineering scenarios to test human-layer defenses
- Performed Active Directory enumeration, privilege escalation, and pass-the-hash / Kerberoasting attacks
- Delivered comprehensive, client-ready penetration testing reports with detailed findings and remediation recommendations
- Collaborated remotely with cross-functional security teams maintaining high-quality deliverables across multiple engagements

Junior Penetration Tester | Freelance

2023 – 2024 (1 Year)

- Conducted security assessments and vulnerability audits on client web applications and infrastructure
- Identified and reported critical vulnerabilities, providing clear remediation guidance that improved client security posture
- Reduced client risk exposure through implementation of targeted security controls and countermeasures
- Produced detailed technical and executive-level security reports tailored to audience technical depth

President – Cybersecurity Student Society (QCSS) | QUEST University

2021 – 2024 (3 Years)

- Led and organized Capture The Flag (CTF) competitions, penetration testing workshops, and offensive security training sessions
- Mentored 50+ students in ethical hacking, red teaming concepts, and industry certifications
- Managed partnerships with industry professionals, growing community engagement by 20%

Microsoft Learn Student Ambassador | Microsoft

2022 – 2024 (2 Years)

- Delivered hands-on cybersecurity sessions covering offensive security techniques and Microsoft security tooling
- Built and maintained a knowledge-sharing community, promoting technical upskilling across the student body

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Certified Penetration Testing Specialist (CPTS)** – Hack The Box
- **Certified Red Team Analyst (CRTA)** – CyberWarfare Labs
- **Certified Cyber Security Analyst (C3SA)** – CyberWarfare Labs
- **CCEP – Certified Cyber Exploitation Professional** – Red Team Leaders
- **CRTOM – Certified Red Team Operations Manager** – Red Team Leaders
- **Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH)** – CISCO
- **Junior Penetration Tester** – TryHackMe

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Cybersecurity – Specialization: Penetration Testing & Red Teaming | QUEST University 2021 – 2025

- Final Year Project: ReconX – AI-powered automated reconnaissance framework with subdomain takeover detection, CVE integration, and structured PDF/JSON reporting

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Ranked #1 in Pakistan on Hack The Box – GURU Rank, featured in NASA Hall of Fame
- Top 5% globally on TryHackMe
- Selected to compete in IRAN OLYMPIC CTF 2025 and advanced to the on-site finals in Iran
- President of QUEST Cybersecurity Student Society (3 years)

TECHNICAL SKILLS & TOOLS

Offensive Tools: Metasploit, Cobalt Strike, Burp Suite, Nmap, Nessus, BloodHound, Impacket, Responder, Mimikatz, SQLmap, Nikto

Red Team: C2 Frameworks, Lateral Movement, Phishing Campaigns, Adversary Simulation, OPSEC

Web AppSec: OWASP Top 10, API Testing, Authentication Bypass, SSRF, XXE, IDOR, Business Logic Flaws

Network: Active Directory Attacks, Kerberoasting, Pass-the-Hash, MITM, Pivoting, Tunneling

Scripting: Python, Bash, PowerShell

Platforms: Linux (Kali, Parrot), Windows Server, AWS (exposure)

AVAILABILITY & LOGISTICS

Notice Period: Immediately available / Less than 1 month

Nationality: Pakistani

Location: Open to relocation – Riyadh, KSA (On-site)

Visa: Requires KSA sponsorship